



Risk Mitigation Case Brief

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Case A: Microsoft

Microsoft is a large company that during the COVID19 pandemic transitioned to the cloud and adopted widespread remote work. This transition introduced more cyber security challenges such as data breaches and unauthorized access to Microsoft networks. Which made Microsoft adopt a new approach to security. Microsoft mitigated such vulnerabilities by using the Zero Trust model. Which includes MFA (multifactor authentication) and regular security audits. Having a policy of "never trust always verify" significantly reduced the risks their system was facing. A very proactive response in my opinion they're preventing attackers from accessing Microsoft networks. If Microsoft, say, went with a different approach such as risk avoidance and never transitioning to a more digital system they might have not stayed as relevant would have gotten as many customers. especially during and after COVID which was a time where most people relied on digital systems to go about daily life.

Case B: Google

Google owns some of the biggest and most used internet services in the world, such as the google search engine, youtube, and gmail. This makes it a common target for cyberattacks, so in 2014 they created Project Zero to not only protect their assets but improve worldwide software security. They introduced bug bounty programs and Public disclosure policies. Project Zero has been extremely successful in identifying and patching vulnerabilities and supporting the digital ecosystem. It was a proactive way to manage risk finding and eliminating vulnerabilities before anyone can exploit them. Another way Google could have managed risk would be risk acceptance. Which likely would have led to vast amounts of vulnerabilities being exploited (compared to how they did manage the risk) and less customer trust in Google.

Case C: JP Morgan Chase

JP Morgan Chase is highly targeted by cyber criminals due to it being a part of the financial sector. If adversaries gain access to their systems they gain direct access to financial assets and sensitive customer information. In 2014 they experienced a massive data breach, which affected millions of customers. Due to this JPMorgan Chase decided they needed to overhaul their cybersecurity posture. JP Morgan increased their annual cybersecurity budget to 600 million, doubled their cyber security workforce, and implemented highly sophisticated technologies. This enhanced the bank's abilities to detect and deal with threats. A very reactive response, they only improved after the worst case happened. If JPMorgan instead transferred their cybersecurity responsibility to another company, I think the outcome would have been very similar. Instead of hiring experts themselves and implementing technologies themselves they could have just outsourced.